

they're doing.

Yes, it's a simplistic example, but it serves our purpose here.

2.1.2.2 Make them take something home

Yes, you've heard that a presentation should create an impact, but what exactly does that mean? Simply stated, it means that at the end of it all, your audience should have some recall of what you said and showed. Now recall can be ensured by several elements:

- Good visuals
- Concise messages
- Intelligent organisation
- Smooth flow
- Questions answered

... and more. We'll get to a couple of these.

2.1.2.3 Be brief

Now this is fine in theory and difficult in practice. But it is a must. Attention spans are notoriously limited when it comes to being at a presentation; it's almost exactly the opposite of playing an addictive game. At the risk of sounding like pedantic priests, we say, you *must* ensure brevity.

Authorities on the subject have suggested that there be not more than five words per line, and not more than five lines per slide. You might not quite be able to do this all the time, but it's a good idea to try. Fact of the matter: you've been to presentations. How much of the text did you read?

It's not only in the interest of catering to short attention spans. It's also about how much a brain can absorb from a slide in that

Tip

Never, ever underestimate the importance of recall! Do you remember the last presentation you went to? What did the speaker say? "He went on about..." is probably what you'd answer. And so that wasn't a good presentation. Figure your own ways to enhance recall. We've just scratched the surface.